

NIKHIL MAHARANA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Full-stack developer with internship experience across Django/DRF backends and a MERN stack (React, Node, Express, MongoDB) in an Agile team. Built and deployed Gossiphy end-to-end — auth, feed, and CRUD — and Progress AI, an LLM-backed study assistant with its own REST layer. Comfortable owning a feature from API design through the React UI, currently finishing an MCA with an 8.5 CGPA.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, JavaScript, Java, C

Frameworks: Django, Django REST Framework (DRF), React, Node.js, Express.js

Databases: MySQL, SQLite, MongoDB, PostgreSQL (basic)

AI / ML: NumPy, Pandas, Matplotlib, NLP/LLM API Integration, scikit-learn (basic)

Tools & Platforms: Git, GitHub, Postman, VS Code, PythonAnywhere, Docker (basic)

Core Concepts: REST API Design, JWT Authentication, Django ORM, OOP, DBMS, DSA, MVC/MVT, System Architecture, Agile

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

MERN Stack Developer Intern — Hexaphor Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

Mar 2026 – June 2026

- Built and shipped multiple full-stack web application modules using MongoDB, Express.js, React, and Node.js in an Agile sprint environment
- Designed and integrated RESTful API endpoints with React frontend components, enabling seamless data flow across 3+ application features
- Implemented CRUD operations with optimized MongoDB queries, reducing average data retrieval time for key user-facing views
- Collaborated in daily code reviews and debugging sessions with senior developers, improving overall module stability

Python Full Stack Developer Intern — Web Bocket Pvt. Ltd.

May 2025 – Jul 2025

- Developed and tested RESTful API endpoints using Django and DRF for multiple backend services, integrated with frontend views
- Built backend logic for authentication flows, form processing, and database operations using Django ORM on a production codebase
- Performed exploratory data analysis on real-world datasets (weather logs, structured CSVs) using Pandas and NumPy; visualized insights with Matplotlib
- Participated in bug triage and code reviews, identifying and resolving 10+ reported issues across the internship duration

PROJECTS

Gossiphy — Full-Stack Social Media Platform | Django · DRF · SQLite · Python

Live: nikhilgudu2.pythonanywhere.com | GitHub: github.com/nikhilmaharana/Gossiphy

- Built a production-deployed social media platform featuring user registration, authentication, post creation, social feed, and CRUD operations using Django and Django ORM
- Designed RESTful API endpoints with Django REST Framework including token-based authentication and role-based permission controls
- Optimized database queries using ORM `select_related` and `prefetch_related` to improve feed pagination response time
- Deployed on PythonAnywhere with WSGI configuration; managed static file serving and environment-based settings for production

Progress AI — Personalized Learning Assistant | Python · Django · NLP/LLM API

GitHub: github.com/nikhilmaharana/Progress-AI

- Developed an AI-powered learning assistant that analyzes user study input via NLP/LLM API calls to generate personalized recommendations and study plans

- Engineered custom prompt templates and integrated third-party LLM APIs to deliver context-aware, goal-specific responses
- Implemented a persistent progress tracking system enabling longitudinal monitoring of user learning patterns and engagement
- Built decoupled RESTful backend endpoints to isolate AI processing from the frontend layer, improving maintainability

EDUCATION

Master of Computer Applications (MCA)
CGPA: 8.5 / 10

Aug 2024 – June 2026

Bachelor of Science — Physics
CGPA: 6.7 / 10

Dec 2021 – May 2024

CERTIFICATIONS

- NPTEL — Programming in Java (Score: 82%)
- NPTEL — Introduction to IoT (Score: 80%)

ACHIEVEMENTS & ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- Secured 2 industry internships as an MCA fresher — demonstrating proactive job-seeking and technical readiness
- Deployed a live full-stack social media platform (Gossiphy) accessible on the web, used as a portfolio demonstration in technical interviews
- Maintained 8.5 CGPA in MCA while working on personal AI/ML and backend projects simultaneously

Languages: English (professional), Hindi, Odia
Interests: Open-source development, AI/LLM applications, content creation, singing